Incident report INC-2026-041: merchant payouts delayed on 24 March 2026

Larkspur Payments (fictional demo data). Severity: SEV-3. Incident commander: Tamar Abashidze. Status: resolved.

Summary

The nightly settlement run that started on 24 March 2026 finished 6 hours late, so merchant payouts for 24 March were sent on the morning of 25 March instead of overnight. Card payments were not affected: payments were accepted and recorded normally the whole night.

Affected services

- **settlement-batch**: the run waited on table locks and then ran slowly.
- **ledger-db**: the nightly backup and the settlement run competed for the same tables.

Root cause

Change CHG-1222 moved the settlement run from 01:00 UTC to 23:00 UTC, the same time as the nightly ledger-db backup. The backup holds table locks for about 40 minutes, and the settlement run waited behind them.

Resolution

CHG-1222 was reverted on 26 March: settlement runs at 01:00 UTC again.